including over 30,000 swayamsevaks representing 96 per cent blocks (239), 70 per cent circles (1,511) and 90 per cent urban localities in upper Assam. As many as 14,000 families in Guwahati, it said, had contributed to organising the programme. In Tripura, a year earlier, the RSS's sarsanghchalak, Mohan Bhagwat, had attended a similarly large Hindu Sammelan in Agartala. The Sangh claimed that it reached 1 lakh households, each of which hoisted saffron flags on its directive. 'The invitations were delivered personally and not through the usual technological tools.' As many as 26,000 people attended the public meeting, and there were representatives from half the region's villages (505 of 1,043). As the Sangh's annual report reported, 'A plan to contact each and every tribal group was prepared and Gurupujan, Raksha Bandhan, Vijaydashami programmes took the process forward … This programme organized in the Northeastern state of Tripura was effective in every sense.'[121] Bhagwat underlined the fact that the gathering took place while Tripura was still under Communist rule and thus showed 'the growing acceptability of RSS in the cross-sections of the society'.[122]

The cultural integration of the Northeast has always been one of the core priorities of the Sangh. Former pracharak and then BJP general secretary Ram Madhav pointed out in 2018 that, for years, not a single annual gathering of the Sangh's highest decision-making bodies—the Karyakarini or the Pratinidhi Sabha—had concluded without passing a Northeast-linked resolution. 'These were treated as challenges for our ideological cause.'[123] Such is the Northeast's importance that Tripura was created as a separate 'prant' in the RSS's organisational hierarchy in 2018.[124] As Mohan Bhagwat declared, 'For us, in Tripura, the Sangh work has increased, we have developed a team there to take care of the work and, therefore, now it is considered as a separate Prant.'[125]

Ram Madhav attributed regional growth to this kind of penetration by the RSS and its network of institutions like the ABVKA, Ekal Vidyalayas and other affiliates. 'Today, the BJP has grown into a big entity in a number of Northeastern states, but the core remains those who have been brought forward by the Sangh years ago. In Tripura, four of the Sangh Pracharaks were kidnapped